



# THE YOLO DIET

(You Only Live Once) Diet

#theyolodiet



This is the World's Greatest Diet for people who want to enjoy life, great food and have fun!



BY A DORKY DIVA

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# THE **YOLO** DIET

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This is the World's Greatest Diet for people who want to enjoy life, great food and have fun!

**BY A DORKY DIVA**

## DISCLAIMER

*This book's purpose is to entertain, possibly educate and maybe instruct. While this book may be helpful and funny, you should obviously consult a doctor about weight loss and your health.*

*Most people want to be healthy and have heard every bit of diet advise known to man. This book was written to remind us/we/you only live once (YOLO) and maybe eating Nachos is what your body and soul needs. Some of the products, companies and techniques mentioned in this book are not always the best choices, but sometimes they are. Neither the author or publisher shall be held liable or responsible for any actual or perceived loss or damage to a person or entity while enjoying The YOLO Diet.*

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# The YOLO Diet

The YOLO Diet - #theyolodiet

*Have you been searching for the perfect diet? The diet that makes you feel extra GREAT? The diet you can enjoy at Breweries? Mexican Food Restaurants? Italian Restaurants? A diet where you can eat bread, carbs, salads, meat or pretty much anything your heart desires? Do you want a diet that allows all your favorite drinks including wine and beer? A diet that allows you to have total stress free eating?. Do you want a diet that eliminates guilt with eating? A diet where you don't have to measure food, count calories, count carbs, eat certain hours or take a diet pill? Do you want a diet that where you can go out with your friends and not be a weirdo with all of your food requirements?*

*The YOLO Diet teaches you how to live your life, love your body, be less judgy and start feeling alive! Are you sick of diets and commercials that try to sell you every new fad and diet pill that comes along? We are too and that is why we created the YOLO Diet! The You Only Live Once Diet! Do you want to be hangry all the time? ... or do you want to live your life and enjoy all the deliciousness out in the world?*

*Listen... our days are numbered and most of us have spent enough of our lives being on a diet and hating our bodies. Let's love our bodies and all that they can do! That doesn't mean we eat junk food all day long... because we DO want to be healthy. The YOLO Diet is all about living YOUR life! If you want a Churro at the fair ... have one! If you want popcorn at the movies ... have some! The key is to enjoy these foods without giving yourself or others judgement or guilt. Remember stress can cause fat too ... so enjoy and savor the foods you choose to eat ... including salads if that is what you want!*

*Do you want to lose weight? Ya, we all do... but you know what is more valuable than weight? **YOU!!!!** Your Soul, your friendships, your love, your mental health, your happiness. It is time for all of us to listen to our own bodies and let them tell us what they need. You will be surprised when you listen to your own body what will happen with your weight. You will not gain weight, you will balance your mind, your cravings and your satisfaction. More than likely, you will start to see weight disappear and it won't make sense. It will be hard in the beginning to unlearn everything you have been taught or read in magazines about diets. We have all tried a million different ways to lose weight with some results, but find those plans are unsustainable and we go back to our old ways. Then we have guilt, get mad at ourselves and binge eat. **It is time to stop the roller coaster dieting and join #theyolodiet movement!***

*We hope you enjoy our cookbook, enjoy your life and enjoy being free at last to live your best life EVER! Because... REMEMBER... You Only Live Once!*

**\*Like and follow our Facebook page The YOLO Diet and be sure to tag #theyolodiet when you are out enjoying life and eating your favorite foods!**

*God Bless - A Dorky Diva & the YOLO Diet Team*

## About the Author

Krista Renning AKA "A Dorky Diva" is one of those people who loves adventure, travel and exploring new restaurants. There aren't many foods Krista doesn't like ... although Lima Beans might make the list. Krista and her husband have been on every sort of Diet trying to keep the weight off. They have tried Keto, Intermittent Fasting, drinking shakes, the Mediterranean Diet, Protein Bars, Pills, Exercise and pretty much anything else you can name. Yes, they have had some results with these diets, but they also missed out on opportunities like going out with friends and family because they didn't want the food temptations and would feel awkward sitting at a restaurant drinking a shake. Being on a Diet tends to keep you on a cycle of guilt feeling that you are being bad or good. This mindset can make the brain crazy and affect our mental health causing high levels of anxiety.

Krista finally decided enough was enough and made a joke that she was just going to be on the YOLO Diet. The "You Only Live Once" Diet and she was going to love her body how it is and enjoy delicious meals with friends and family when the opportunities came up. When Krista eats savory things or even Cotton Candy, she will say "this is on the YOLO Diet" and that makes her happy! Her whole philosophy is "you do you" and "live YOUR life in ways that bring you joy". That is why Krista turned her joke into a new way of living guilt free and created The YOLO Diet (#theyolodiet)

Krista is currently exploring the country in her RV with her husband and Deaf Chihuahua Horchata while enjoying #theyolodiet!



**ALL COCKTAILS  
ARE ON  
#THEYOLODIET**



## ***Bloody Mary***



**PREP TIME:**  
5 Min



**SERVINGS**  
1

### **Ingredients**

- 2 oz vodka
- 4 oz tomato juice
- 1/2 oz lemon juice
- 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1/2 tsp hot sauce
- Pinch of salt and pepper
- Celery stalk and lime wedge for garnish

### **Directions**

1. Combine the vodka with tomato juice, lemon juice, Worcestershire sauce, hot sauce, salt, and pepper in a shaker. Shake well to combine.
2. Pour over ice into a tall glass. Garnish with celery and lime wedge. Serve immediately.



## ***Draft Beer***



**PREP TIME:**  
2 Min



**SERVINGS**  
1

### **Ingredients**

- 1 pint of your favorite beer
- Lime wedge for garnish

### **Directions**

1. Pour the beer into a chilled pint glass. Garnish with a lime wedge. Serve immediately.



## Mojito



**PREP TIME:**  
5 Min



**SERVINGS**  
1

### Ingredients

- 2 oz white rum
- $\frac{3}{4}$  oz lime juice
- 1 oz simple syrup
- 6-8 mint leaves
- Club soda
- Lime wedge and mint sprig for garnish

### Directions

1. Muddle the mint leaves with fresh lime juice and simple syrup in a shaker. Add rum and fill the shaker with ice.
2. Shake well to combine. Strain into a highball glass and fill it with ice. Top with club soda. Garnish with a lime wedge and mint.
3. Serve immediately.



## ***Pina Colada***



**PREP TIME:**  
5 Min



**SERVINGS**  
1

### **Ingredients**

- 2 oz white rum
- 2 oz pineapple juice
- 2 oz coconut cream
- Pineapple wedge and cherry for garnish

### **Directions**

1. Combine the rum, pineapple juice, and coconut cream in the high-power blender. Blend until smooth. Pour into the hurricane glass filled with ice.
2. Garnish with a pineapple wedge and cherry. Serve immediately.



## Old Fashioned



**PREP TIME:**  
5 Min



**SERVINGS**  
1

### Ingredients

- 2 oz bourbon or rye whiskey
- 1 sugar cube
- 2 dashes of Angostura bitters
- Orange slice and cherry for garnish

### Directions

1. In a glass, muddle the sugar cube with the bitter and a splash of water. Fill the glass with ice. Add the whiskey and stir well.
2. Garnish with an orange slice and cherry. Serve immediately.

**ALL APPETIZERS  
ARE ON  
#THEYOLODIET**



## Nachos



**PREP TIME:**  
25 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 8 oz. tortilla chips
- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese
- ½ cup refried beans
- ½ cup diced tomatoes
- ¼ cup sliced jalapeños
- Sour cream and chopped cilantro for garnish

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Arrange the tortilla chips in one layer on a baking sheet. Sprinkle the cheese evenly over the chips.
2. Spoon the refried beans over the cheese. Sprinkle the diced tomatoes and sliced jalapeños over the beans.
3. Bake for 13-15 minutes. Garnish with a dollop of cream and chopped cilantro. Serve immediately.



## Chicken Wings



**PREP TIME:**  
60 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 2 lb. chicken wings
- 2 tbs olive oil
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 2 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ¼ cup BBQ sauce

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F. In a large bowl, combine the chicken wings with olive oil, smoked paprika, garlic powder, salt, and crushed black pepper.
2. Toss the coat evenly. Arrange the chicken wings in one layer on a baking sheet.
3. Bake for 37-40 minutes or until crispy and cooked through. Brush the chicken wings with BBQ sauce.
4. Bake for 5-10 minutes or until the sauce is caramelized and sticky. Serve immediately.



## Artichoke Dip



**PREP TIME:**  
35 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 1 can (14 oz weight) artichoke hearts, drained and chopped
- 1 cup shredded mozzarella cheese
- ½ cup grated Parmesan cheese
- ½ cup mayonnaise
- ½ cup sour cream
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried basil
- Salt and crushed pepper to taste

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Combine the chopped artichoke hearts, shredded mozzarella cheese, grated Parmesan cheese, mayonnaise, sour cream, minced garlic, dried basil, salt, and pepper in a bowl.
2. Mix well to combine. Transfer the mixture to a baking dish. Bake for 23-25 minutes until the top is golden brown and the dip is bubbly. Serve immediately with tortilla chips, crackers, or vegetables.



## Charcuterie Board



**PREP TIME:**  
10 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 8 oz. Assorted cured meats (such as salami, prosciutto, and pepperoni)
- 8 oz. Assorted cheeses (such as cheddar, brie, and gouda)
- 8 oz. Crackers or bread
- 4 oz. Assorted nuts (such as almonds and cashews)
- 4 oz. Fresh fruit (such as grapes and berries)
- 4 oz. Olives
- 2 tbsp. honey or jam for drizzling

### Directions

1. Arrange the cured meats, cheeses, crackers/bread, nuts, fruit, and olives on a large serving platter or board. Drizzle honey or jam over the cheese.
2. Serve immediately.



## Brussel Sprouts



**PREP TIME:**  
35 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 1 lb. Brussels sprouts, trimmed and halved
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- $\frac{1}{2}$  tsp salt
- $\frac{1}{4}$  tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp honey
- 2 tbsp balsamic vinegar

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400F. In a bowl, toss the halved sprouts with olive oil, salt, and black pepper. Arrange the Brussels sprouts in one layer on a baking sheet.
2. Roast for 23-25 minutes or until tender and caramelized. In a bowl, whisk the honey with balsamic vinegar. Drizzle the honey balsamic glaze over the Brussels sprouts.
3. Toss the coat evenly. Serve immediately.

**ALL MAIN  
DISHES ARE ON  
#THEYOLODIET**



## ***Lasagna***



**PREP TIME:**  
80 Min



**SERVINGS**  
8

### **Ingredients**

- 1 lb. ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 (28 oz) can of crushed tomatoes
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh basil
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh oregano
- Salt and crushed black pepper to taste
- 1 lb. lasagna noodles
- 4 cups shredded mozzarella cheese
- 1½ cups ricotta cheese
- ½ cup grated Parmesan cheese

### **Directions**

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. Put the large skillet over medium heat, and cook the ground beef, onion, and garlic for 7-10 minutes.
2. Add the crushed tomatoes, tomato paste, basil, oregano, salt, and pepper to the skillet. Take the mixture to a simmer and cook for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Meanwhile, cook the lasagna noodles according to the package directions. Combine the ricotta cheese and 2 cups of shredded mozzarella cheese in a bowl.
4. To assemble the lasagna, spread a layer of meat sauce on the bottom of a 9x13-inch baking dish. Add a layer of cooked lasagna noodles, followed by a layer of cheese mixture.
5. Repeat these layers, ending with a layer of meat sauce on top. Sprinkle the remaining shredded mozzarella cheese and the grated Parmesan cheese over the top. Bake for 30-35 minutes or until the cheese is melted and bubbly. Allow the lasagna to cool for a few minutes before slicing and serving.



## ***Bacon Cheeseburger***



**PREP TIME:**  
25 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### **Ingredients**

- 1 lb. ground beef
- Salt and black pepper, to taste
- 4 hamburger buns
- 4 slices of cheddar cheese
- 8 slices of bacon, cooked
- 1/2 onion, sliced
- 4 lettuce leaves
- 4 tomato slices
- Ketchup and mustard, to taste

### **Directions**

1. Preheat a grill over medium-high heat. Season the ground beef with salt and black pepper. Form the beef into 4 patties. Grill the burgers for 5-7 minutes for each side.
2. During the last minute of cooking, add a slice of cheddar cheese to each burger and allow it to melt. Toast the hamburger buns on the grill. Assemble the burgers by placing a patty on the bottom half of each bun.
3. Top with 2 slices of bacon, some sliced onion, a lettuce leaf, and a tomato slice. Add ketchup and mustard to taste, then top with the remaining half of the bun. Serve immediately.



## Asian Stir Fry



**PREP TIME:**  
30 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 1 lb. chicken breast (without bone), sliced into thin pieces
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- 1 yellow onion, sliced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp. vegetable oil
- 2 tbsp. soy sauce
- 1 tbsp. hoisin sauce
- 1 tbsp. honey
- 1 tbsp. cornstarch
- 1 tsp. sesame oil
- Salt and crushed pepper to taste

### Directions

1. Heat two tbsp vegetable oil in a wok or large skillet over medium-high heat. Add the sliced chicken and cook for 3-4 minutes or until browned. Add the broccoli, bell pepper, onion, and garlic to the skillet and stir-fry for 3-4 minutes.
2. In a bowl, whisk the soy sauce with hoisin sauce, honey, cornstarch, sesame oil, salt, and pepper. Pour the sauce over the Asian stir fry and toss to coat. Cook for 1-2 minutes or until the sauce has thickened. Serve hot over rice.



## Enchilada Casserole



**PREP TIME:**  
60 Min



**SERVINGS**  
6

### Ingredients

- 1 pound ground beef
- 1 can (15 oz weight) black beans, rinsed and drained
- 1 can (15 oz) corn, drained
- 1 can (10 oz) enchilada sauce
- 1 can (4 oz) diced green chilies
- 1 tsp. ground cumin
- 1 tsp. chili powder
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 6-8 corn tortillas
- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. In a non-stick skillet, cook the ground beef over medium heat until browned. Drain off any excess fat.
2. Add the skillet's black beans, corn, enchilada sauce, green chilies, cumin, chili powder, salt, and pepper. Stir to combine. Grease the rectangular baking dish with cooking spray.
3. Spread a layer of the beef and bean mixture on the bottom of the baking dish. Top with a layer of corn tortillas, overlapping as needed to cover the entire dish.
4. Repeat with another layer of the beef and bean mixture, followed by another layer of tortillas. Top with the remaining beef and bean mixture and sprinkle with shredded cheddar cheese.
5. Bake for 30-35 minutes or until the cheese is melted and bubbly. Let the casserole cool for 5-10 minutes before serving.



## Prime Rib



**PREP TIME:**  
2 hr 45 Min



**SERVINGS**  
8

### Ingredients

- 1 bone-in prime rib roast (5-6 pounds)
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup fresh rosemary, chopped
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup fresh thyme, chopped
- 2 tbsp kosher salt
- 1 tbsp black pepper
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup olive oil

### Directions

1. Remove the prime rib roast from the fridge and put it aside to come to room temperature for 2-3 hours. Preheat the oven to 450°F. Mix the garlic with rosemary, thyme, salt, pepper, and olive oil to paste in a bowl.
2. Rub the paste all over the ribs, and coat it evenly on all sides. Place the rib on a roasting rack in a roasting pan, bone side down.
3. Roast the prime rib for 15 minutes, then decrease the heat to 325°F and cook for approximately 2-2½ hours. Remove the rib and tent it with foil.
4. Let it rest for 15-20 minutes before carving. Serve the prime rib with your favorite sides, such as roasted vegetables or mashed potatoes.

**ALL DESSERTS  
ARE ON  
#THEYOLODIET**



## Key Lime Pie



**PREP TIME:**  
25 Min



**SERVINGS**  
8

### Ingredients

- 1½ cups graham cracker crumbs
- 1/3 cup white sugar
- 6 tbsp butter, melted
- 3 cups sweetened condensed milk
- ½ cup sour cream
- ¾ cup key lime juice
- 1 tbsp grated lime zest
- Whipped cream and lime slices for garnish

### Directions

1. reheat oven to 350°F. Toss the graham cracker crumbs with sugar and melted butter in a bowl. Press the mixture into the bottom (with light pressure) and sides of a 9-inch pie dish.
2. Mix condensed milk with sour cream, key lime juice, and zest in a bowl. Pour mixture into crust. Bake in preheated oven for 10 minutes.
3. Chill the pie in the refrigerator for at least 2 hours before serving. Garnish with whipped cream and lime slices before serving.



## Banana Pudding



**PREP TIME:**  
20 Min



**SERVINGS**  
10

### Ingredients

- 1 (14-ounce) can of sweetened condensed milk
- 1½ cups cold water
- 1 (3½ ounce) package of instant vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups heavy cream, whipped
- 36 vanilla wafers
- 3 medium bananas, sliced
- Whipped cream and additional vanilla wafers for garnish

### Directions

1. In a bowl, whisk the sweetened condensed milk with water until well combined. Add pudding mix and continue to whisk for 2 minutes or until the mixture has thickened.
2. Gently fold in whipped cream until fully combined. Layer vanilla wafers, sliced bananas, and pudding mixture in the rectangular baking dish. Repeat layers until all are used, ending with a layer of pudding mixture.
3. Refrigerate for 2 hours or until set. Garnish with additional whipped cream and vanilla wafers before serving.



## Strawberry Cheesecake



**PREP TIME:**  
65 Min



**SERVINGS**  
8

### Ingredients

- 1½ cups graham cracker crumbs
- ¼ cup white sugar
- ½ cup butter, melted
- 4 (8-ounce) packages of cream cheese, softened
- 1¼ cups white sugar
- 1 tsp. vanilla extract
- 4 eggs
- 1/3 cup strawberry preserves
- Fresh strawberries for garnish

### Directions

1. Preheat oven to 350F. Mix the graham cracker crumbs with ¼ cup sugar and melted butter in a bowl. Add the mixture to the 9-inch springform pan.
2. In a bowl, beat cream cheese, 1¼ cups sugar, and vanilla extract until creamy. Beat in eggs until fully combined. Pour half of the cream cheese mixture into the prepared crust.
3. Drop spoonfuls of strawberry preserves onto the cream cheese mixture. Pour the remaining cream cheese mixture over the strawberry layer. Bake in preheated oven for 45-50 minutes or until the center is almost set.
4. Run a knife around the pan edges, remove the cake, slice, and serve.



## Chocolate Chocolate Cake



**PREP TIME:**  
1 hr 15 Min



**SERVINGS**  
8-10

### Ingredients

- 1¾ cups all-purpose flour
- ¾ cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 cups granulated sugar
- 1½ tsp baking powder
- 1½ tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 cup buttermilk at room temperature
- ½ cup vegetable oil
- 2 large eggs at room temperature
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup boiling water
- Chocolate frosting of your choice

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350F (175°C). Grease and flour two round cake pans (around 9 inches). Sift the flour with cocoa powder, sugar, baking powder, soda, and salt in a bowl.
2. In a bowl, whisk the buttermilk with vegetable oil, eggs, and vanilla extract. Gradually mix the wet and dry ingredients, stirring until just combined.
3. Pour in the boiling water and stir until the batter is smooth. Divide the batter evenly between the pans. Bake for 33-35 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes clean.
4. Cool the cakes in the pans for 10 minutes before removing them and cooling them completely on wire racks. Frost the cake with chocolate frosting and serve.



## Crème Brûlée



**PREP TIME:**  
1 hr 20 Min



**SERVINGS**  
4

### Ingredients

- 2 cups heavy cream
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 4 large egg yolks
- 4 tbsp granulated sugar (for topping)

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 325F (165°C). Place four ramekins in a baking dish. In a non-stick saucepan, heat the heavy cream, sugar, and vanilla extract over medium heat until just simmering.
2. In a bowl, whisk the egg yolks, then gradually add the hot cream mixture, whisking constantly. Pour the mixture into a measuring cup.
3. Pour the mixture evenly into the ramekins. Add the boiling water into the baking dish until the sides of the ramekins are half-covered. Bake for 47-50 minutes or until the custard is set.
4. Remove the ramekins from the oven dish and refrigerate for 2 hours. When ready to serve, sprinkle 1 tablespoon of sugar over each custard and use a kitchen torch to caramelize the sugar.

**ALL PARTY  
FOODS ARE ON  
#THEYOLODIET**



## Mini Pizzas



**PREP TIME:**  
35 Min



**SERVINGS**  
24 mini pizzas

### Ingredients

- 1 package of pizza dough
- 1 cup of tomato sauce
- 2 cups of shredded mozzarella cheese
- Your choice of pizza toppings (pepperoni, sausage, mushrooms, etc.)

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 450F (230°C). Roll out the pizza dough with a round cookie cutter to cut out 24 circles. Place the pizza dough circles on a baking sheet.
2. Spread a tablespoon of tomato sauce on each pizza dough circle. Add your choice of pizza toppings to each pizza. Top each pizza with shredded mozzarella cheese.
3. Bake the mini pizzas for 10-12 minutes. Serve hot.



## ***Pigs in a Blanket***



**PREP TIME:**  
30 Min



**SERVINGS**  
24 Pigs in a Blanket

### **Ingredients**

- 1 package of crescent roll dough
- 24 cocktail sausages
- ¼ cup of melted butter
- 2 tbsp of chopped parsley
- Ketchup and mustard for serving

### **Directions**

1. Preheat the oven to 375F (190°C). Roll out the crescent dough and cut it into 24 triangles. Place a cocktail sausage at the wide end of each triangle and roll it up.
2. Put the pigs in a blanket on the oven sheet. Brush the melted butter on top of the pigs in a blanket. Sprinkle chopped parsley on top. Bake the pigs in a blanket for 15-20 minutes or until golden brown.
3. Serve hot with ketchup and mustard.



## Macaroni Bites



**PREP TIME:**  
40 Min



**SERVINGS**  
24 Macaroni Bites

### Ingredients

- 2 cups of cooked elbow macaroni
- 1 cup of shredded cheddar cheese
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup of milk
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup of butter
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup of all-purpose flour
- $\frac{1}{2}$  tsp of salt
- $\frac{1}{4}$  tsp of black pepper
- $\frac{1}{4}$  tsp of garlic powder
- 2 eggs, beaten
- 1 cup of breadcrumbs
- $\frac{1}{4}$  cup of grated parmesan cheese
- Cooking spray

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375F (190°C). In a bowl, mix the cooked elbow macaroni and shredded cheddar cheese. In a non-stick saucepan, melt the butter over medium heat.
2. Add the flour, salt, crushed black pepper, and garlic powder to the saucepan and whisk together. Gradually add the milk to the saucepan and whisk until smooth.
3. Add the milk mixture to the bowl with the macaroni and cheese and mix. Stir in the beaten eggs. Grease a mini muffin box with cooking spray.
4. In the other bowl, toss the breadcrumbs with grated parmesan cheese. Spoons the macaroni mixture into the mini muffin tin using a cookie scoop.
5. Sprinkle the breadcrumb mixture on top of each macaroni bite. Bake the macaroni bites for 15-20 minutes or until golden brown. Serve hot.



## Cake Pops



**PREP TIME:**  
1 hr 30 Min



**SERVINGS**  
24

### Ingredients

- 1 box cake mix, any flavor
- 1 container frosting, any flavor
- 24 cake pop sticks
- 1 package of candy melts, any flavor
- Sprinkles, optional

### Directions

1. Preheat the oven. Grease a 9x13-inch baking dish. Prepare the cake mix as instructed on the box.
2. Pour the batter into the greased dish and bake for the recommended time. Let the cake cool for 3-4 mins, then crumble it into a large bowl.
3. Add the container of frosting to the bowl and mix it with the cake crumbs until well combined. Use a cookie scoop or tablespoon to form the mixture into small balls.
4. Place them on a parchment-lined baking sheet. Chill the cake balls for thirty minutes. Melt the candy in a microwave-safe bowl according to the package instructions.
5. Insert a cake pop stick into each chilled cake ball, then dip the cake pop into the melted candy coating. Tap off any excess coating and place it back on the parchment-lined baking sheet.
6. Decorate the cake pops with sprinkles, if desired, while the candy coating is still wet. Let the coating harden completely before serving.



## Swedish Meatballs



**PREP TIME:**  
50 Min



**SERVINGS**  
6

### Ingredients

#### For the Meatballs:

- 1 lb. ground beef
- ½ lb. ground pork
- ½ cup breadcrumbs
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 egg
- ½ onion, finely chopped
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp ground allspice
- ¼ tsp ground nutmeg

#### For the Gravy:

- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp flour
- 2 cups beef broth
- ½ cup heavy cream
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- Salt and crushed pepper, to taste
- Chopped fresh parsley for garnish

### Directions

1. Toss the ground beef, pork, breadcrumbs, milk, egg, onion, garlic, salt, black pepper, allspice, and nutmeg in a bowl. Mix well. Shape the mixture into small meatballs about 1 inch in diameter.
2. Put the non-stick skillet over medium-high heat. Add the meatballs and cook for 8-10 minutes. Remove the meatballs and set them aside.
3. In the same skillet, melt two tbsp butter over medium heat. Add the flour and constantly whisk for 1-2 minutes until it forms a paste. Slowly whisk in the beef broth and heavy cream and continue to whisk until the mixture is smooth.
4. Add the Worcestershire sauce, salt, and pepper, and stir well. Return the meatballs to the skillet and spoon the gravy over them. Decrease the stove heat to low and let the meatballs simmer in the gravy for 17-20 minutes until the sauce thickens and the meatballs are fully cooked.
5. Garnish with chopped fresh parsley and serve hot.